

Lesson 2: Data Policies and Privacy

45 minutes

Overview

Students learn that the apps, websites, and other computing innovations they use every day require a lot of data to run, much of which they might consider to be private or personal. In the warm up students discuss which of a list of possible information types they consider private. Then students read the data policies from a website or service they use or know about. This investigation focuses on the kinds of data that are being collected, the way it's being used, and any potential privacy concerns that arise. A brief second activity reveals that even data that may not seem private, like a birthdate or zipcode, can be combined to uniquely identify them. To conclude the lesson students prepare for a discussion in the following class about the pros and cons of sharing all this data by journaling about their current thoughts on whether the harms of giving up this privacy are outweighed by the benefits of the technology they power.

Standards

Full Course Alignment

CSP Conceptual Framework

- **IOC-2** - The use of computing innovations may involve risks to your personal safety and identity.

CSTA K-12 Computer Science Standards (2017)

- **IC** - Impacts of Computing

Agenda

Warm Up (5 minutes)

What Information is Private?

Activity (35 minutes)

How to Read a Privacy Policy

Data Policy Exploration

Wrap Up (5 minutes)

Objectives

Students will be able to:

- Define Personally Identifiable Information as information about an individual that identifies, links, relates, or describes them.
- Describe the different types of data that are used and collected by modern computing innovations
- Explain how disparate pieces of personal information can be combined to identify individuals or deduce other private information.

Preparation

- Check a few popular websites with students in your school to make sure they'll be able to access those sites' data policies over your school network.
- Check the "**Teacher's Lounge**" forum for verified teachers to find additional strategies or resources shared by fellow teachers
- If you are teaching virtually, consider checking our **Virtual Lesson**

Modifications

Links

Heads Up! Please make a copy of any documents you plan to share with students.

For the teachers

- **Data Policies and Privacy** - Slides

▼ Make a Copy

For the students

Teaching Guide

Warm Up (5 minutes)

What Information is Private?

 **Discuss:** Which of the following pieces of information would you consider to be "personal", as in you wouldn't want it shared with just anyone.

Teaching Tip

This lesson is closely tied with the one that follows. In today's lesson students focus primarily on understanding the kinds of data that are collected by modern apps, websites, and computing innovations, and the ways that this may sometimes lead to sharing private information. In the following lesson students will specifically discuss the pros and cons of sharing that information.

1. Your full name
2. Your social security number
3. Your favorite musician / band
4. A picture of your face
5. Your fingerprint
6. Your birthdate
7. Your address
8. Where you go after school
9. Your phone number
10. Your medical information
11. Who your best friends are
12. Your racial / ethnic identity
13. A list of everything you've bought this month
14. A list of recordings of your voice
15. Your IP address
16. A video of you singing
17. Your academic history / report card
18. The town or city you live in

Have students brainstorm silently at their tables, then have them share with neighbors, and finally have them share out with the room.

Discussion Goal: This discussion sets up the rest of the lesson where students will be exploring instances where many of the pieces of information on this list are used by the services they use every day. Aim to push students to think about what it means to say that something is "personal" or "private". This is a lens they should take into the lesson.

Also, point out to students the items on this list that are biometric data: a picture of your face, your fingerprint, and voice/video recordings. Are these considered any more private or personal than the other items? Why or why not?

 **Remarks**

We know that computing innovations need data to run, but we don't always think about just how personal or private that information may be. We're about to kick off a two-part lesson. In today's lesson we're going to look at just how much personal data we share online. Tomorrow we'll debate the pros and cons of sharing all that data.

Activity (35 minutes)

How to Read a Privacy Policy (5 minutes)

Remarks

Most good websites and apps will have a privacy policy that explains the data that they collect and the way that it's used. We may have seen them before, but we've probably not read them.

Teaching Tip

Profanity in Video: Note this video briefly includes the written phrase "How to read an f*\$%ing privacy policy" roughly 15 seconds in. Review the video and ensure you're comfortable sharing it in your class. If you need you can start the video later.

Dated Video: This video is from 2018 but makes the point that students should check that privacy policies are recent. Be prepared to let students know that even though this video was shot in 2018, the same principles are important and apply.

 **Display:** Show the **video** about how to read a data privacy policy. Take note of the teaching tip about the date and content of the video to the right.

Data Policy Exploration (25 minutes)

Remarks

Today we're going to practice reading data policies to get a sense for what kinds of information is actually being collected by modern computing innovations like websites and apps. We're going to spend today filling out the front part of the activity guide. In the next lesson we'll think more deeply about whether we think the tradeoffs of privacy are worth it, but you don't need to worry about that side of the activity guide today.

Group: If students like they can work in pairs for today's activity when they will be reading the privacy policy. Each student, however, should be completing their own activity guide.

****Distribute:** ** Give each student a copy of **Privacy, Security, and Innovation**

 **Choose a Website and Find the Data Privacy Policy:** Have students pick a company / app to use. If students are having a hard time picking a specific website, many big technology companies have fairly robust data policy pages, like Facebook, Google, Twitter, Instagram, and so on.

What Is Their Data Policy?: Students should spend 10-15 minutes reviewing the data policies and answering the questions there.

Share Findings: Have groups meet with another group to share what they discovered.

Wrap Up (5 minutes)

 **Review:** Review the key takeaways from the lesson and have students record the definition of Personally Identifiable Information in their journal.

Remarks

Users can control the permission that programs have for collecting their information. As a thoughtful user of technology, don't forget to review the privacy policies of the various apps and programs you use to protect your privacy!

Assessment: Check For Understanding

Check For Understanding Question(s) and solutions can be found in each lesson on Code Studio. These questions can be used for an exit ticket.

Question: Which of the following is NOT a reason that a company would typically collect personally identifiable information (PII)?

Activity Guide: Have students submit their activity guides from today's lesson but be prepared to hand them back out for the following lesson.



Check For Understanding



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